

INSTRUCTION MANUAL

The XMB, taken to the Max.

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Getting Started

Welcome to MaXMB, the XMB taken to the Max. The MaXMB brings the PlayStation®3's XMB (XrossMediaBar) menu to your Windows computer.

Your games, music, photos, videos and the web, all in one place, and all usable with a controller, a keyboard or a mouse.

Before You Begin

To use the MaXMB you need:

- A computer with Windows 10 or Windows 11.
- A controller (Recommended): DualShock®3 (USB), DualShock®4, DualSense® or any type of Xbox controller. A keyboard and mouse also work everywhere.
- FFmpeg: Lets the system convert videos it can't play directly, make video icons, and scrape the art and music of PS3 games recognized by the system.

  You can download it here:
  https://www.gyan.dev/ffmpeg/builds/ffmpeg-release-essentials.zip

  After downloading FFmpeg, open the .zip file, enter inside the bin folder, copy ffmpeg.exe and put it inside resources/ffmpeg.
- LibreWolf: The web browser the system uses to access the internet.

  You can download the Portable version here:
  https://librewolf.net/installation/windows/

  After downloading a portable version of LibreWolf, copy the files inside the “librewolf-*.*.*-*” folder and put them inside content/Browser.

The system keeps everything in its own folder. Your settings, users and media live in their respective content folders, and temporary files go by default to the Windows' Temp folder, unless you enable the option on System Settings > Cache Management > Save Cache in System Directory.

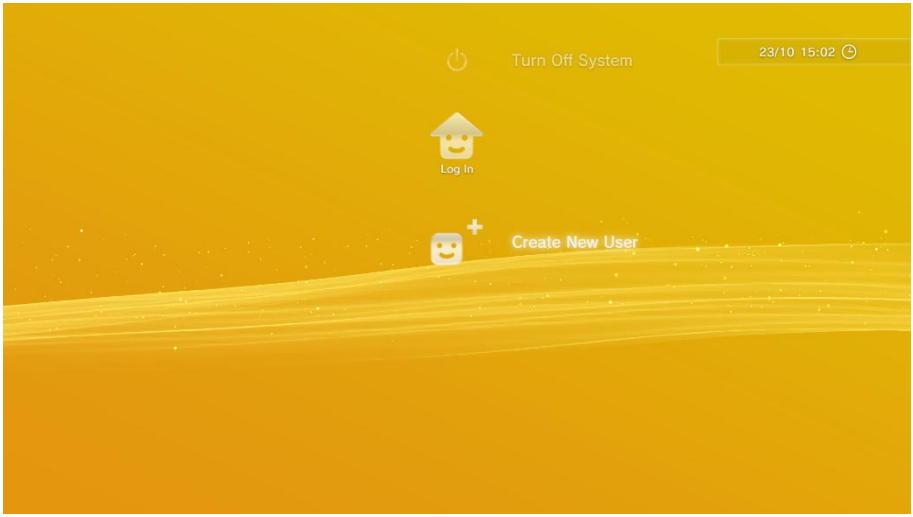
Starting the System

When the system starts for the first time, you can hear the console's startup sound followed by the intro. Press any button to skip the intro.



Users

The system usually opens on the Users category. Each user has their own settings, theme, sections, playlists and PlayStation™Network account saved inside them.



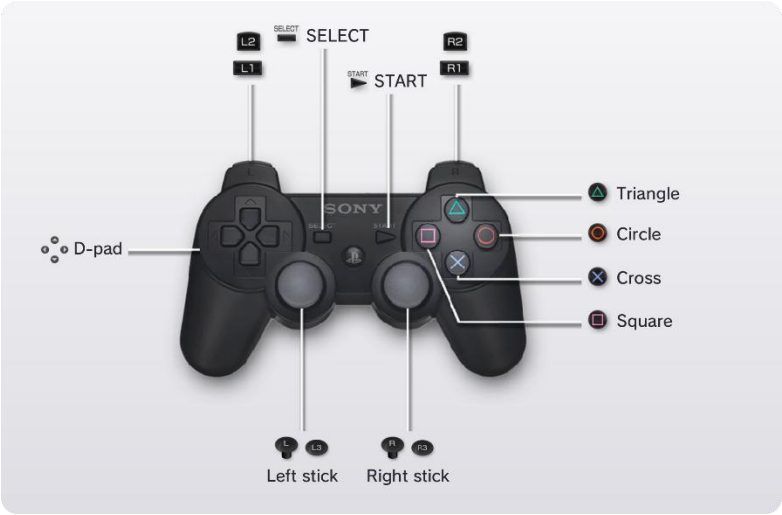
	Create New User	Type a name with the Keyboard and then press the “Ok” button to create and access a new user.
	User	When selecting a User, △ opens the user's options. Here you can “Log Out”, activate “Automatic Login”, “Delete” the User or access the User’s “Information”, where you can change the name or the user’s icon.

NOTE Turn on “Automatic Login” on a User for the system to log into that User right after the intro.

Turning Off the System

Select Turn Off System at the top of the Users category. You can also close the System at any moment by pressing F4 on the keyboard, which is useful if the system suddenly stops responding.

Controls



The system uses the PlayStation® button names. On an Xbox-style controller, the buttons are:

PlayStation®	Xbox-style
✕	A
○	B
□	X
△	Y
SELECT	Back / View
START	Start / Menu
L1 / R1	LB / RB
L2 / R2	LT / RT

Basic Controls

	Move through the menu. Use left and right for moving between categories, and up and down for items.
	Select / Open.
	Go back / Close.
	Open the options of the selected item.
	Change how a category is grouped (Music, Photo, Video, Game and Custom Sections).
	Used inside the media players and some menus.
	Take a screenshot. Screenshots are saved inside the content/Photos/Screenshots folder.

Keyboard and Mouse

Every controller button has a keyboard key equivalent. These are the default keys, and you can change any of them in Settings > System Settings > Change Keybinds.

Keys	Playstation® Equivalent
Arrow Keys / W A S D	
Enter	
Esc	
T	
R	
Q / E	
1 / 3	
F / G	
C	
Space	

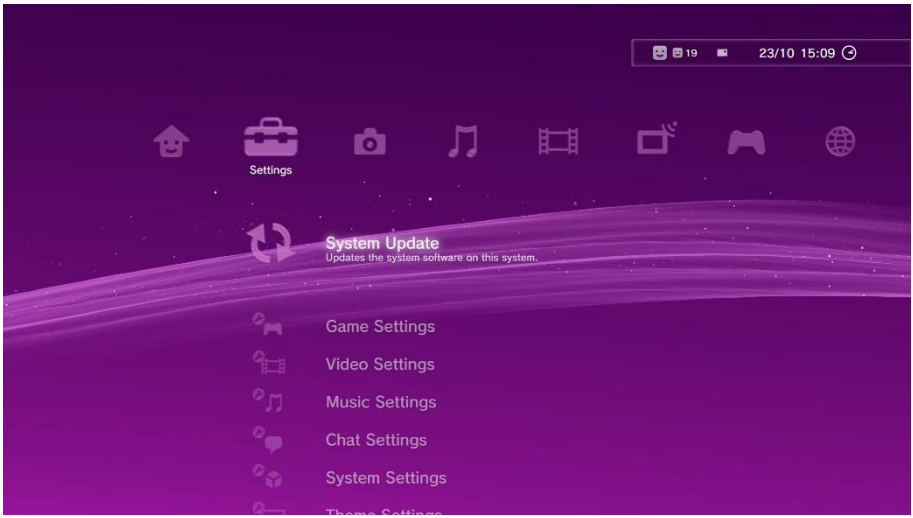
These keys do things of their own:

Key	Does
F12 / R3	Take a screenshot
F10	Hide HUD
F4	Close the system immediately

With the mouse, click on an icon to open its menu and right-click to open its options menu. The mouse wheel moves the menu up and down, and Shift + Wheel moves it between categories. You can also click and drag with your mouse to move around the MaXMB.

The XMB Menu

The XMB is shaped like a cross. The row going across holds the categories, while the column going down holds the items of the selected category. The selected item shows its details, and the box at the top right shows the clock and, once signed in, your PlayStation™Network information.



Categories

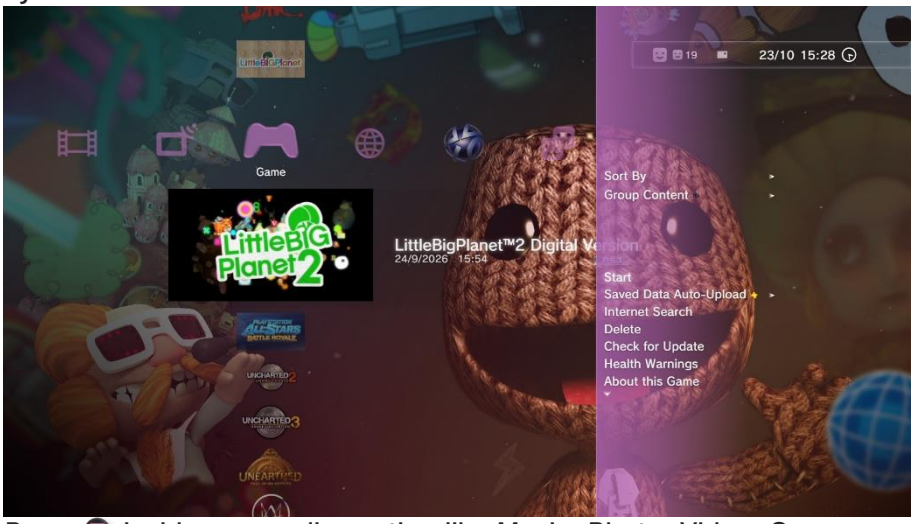
	Users	Log in, switch Users, create new Users or turn off the System.
	Settings	Every customization option inside the system. See “Settings at a Glance” below.
	Photo	Your Pictures, the Photo Gallery, Photo playlists and Screenshots.
	Music	Your Songs and Music playlists.
	Video	Your Videos.

	TV/Video Services	YouTube, opened inside the Browser.
	Game	Your Games.
	Network	The Internet Browser and Internet Search.
	PlayStation™Network	Sign Up or Sign In, manage your Account and customize Friends.
	Friends	Your Friends list and your own player card.

HINT You can add your own categories with Custom Sections. See “Custom Sections”.

Options and Sorting

Press △ on an item to see which options the system allows you to do with it. On a Game, for example, you can boot it, change how Games are sorted (Sort By) and grouped (Group Content), delete it from the system or see its relevant information.



Press □ inside any media section like Music, Photo, Video, Game or a Custom Section to change how its items are grouped, such as “By Album”, “By Title” or “By Date” depending on the type of media.

Playing Games

Select a game and press ⊗ to start it. The system rests while you play, so the game gets all the resources it needs.

> HINT If the system doesn't come back to the front after closing a game, press any button on the controller to make the system come back into focus.

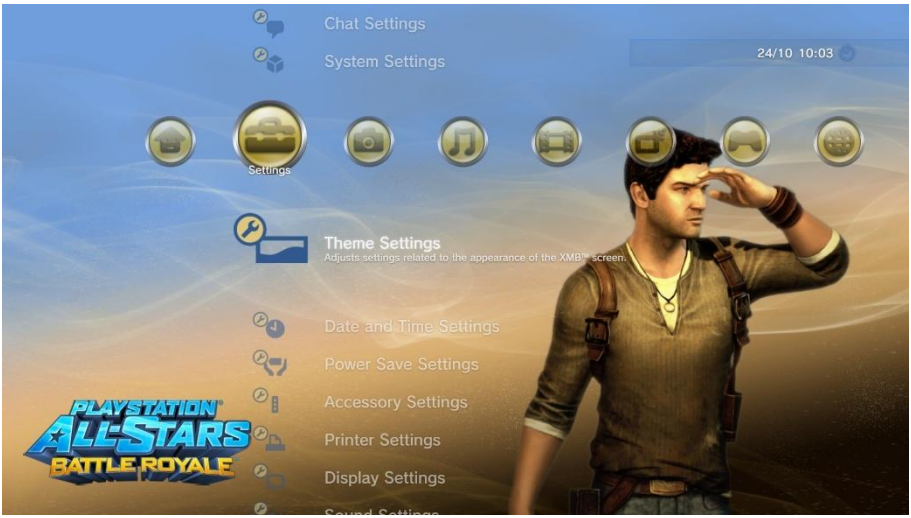
Settings at a Glance

Every setting is changed from its option menu. Select it and press ⊗, choose with the ✣, and press ⊗ again where available. Your settings are saved independently for each user.

	Game Settings	Each game's details, Art, Game Recognition and Game Art Databases.
	Video Settings	Pre-Loading videos.
	Music Settings	Background Music, Pre-Loading songs and the Music Player's Visualizer option.
	System Settings	Media Folders, Custom Sections, Keybinds, Cache and Starting with Windows option.
	Theme Settings	Themes, Backgrounds, Wave, Sparkles, Icons, Fonts and Colors.
	Date and Time Settings	The Date and Time format options.
	Power Save Settings	Lighter options for slower computers.
	Accessory Settings	Enable/Disable the On-Screen Keyboard.
	Display Settings	Resolution, Full Screen, Brightness and Frame rate options.
	Sound Settings	Volume and the System's sound options.

Customization

Almost everything you see and hear can be changed in Settings > Theme Settings. Customization settings are saved inside each individual user.



PS3 Themes	Install real PS3 themes (.p3t files), animated ones included. Choose which individual parts of a theme to use, or extract everything it contains.
Custom Themes	Save your current look as a full theme of your own (A .zip file you can share with other MaXMB Users), and use it again any time you like.
Icon Sets	Replace the default system's icons for personalized Icon Sets, including the icons inside the media players.
Sound Effect Sets	Replace the system's sounds.
Background	A background color, a photo or video as the background, a transparent image or green-screen video overlay over it, and shuffling playlists of pictures and videos among other background options.

	Wave and Sparkles	Turn the wave and sparkles On or Off, change their colors, or adjust every detail about them.
	Icons	The icons' color and style (Default, Glossy or Flat), and your own pictures for use in the intro.
	Text and Color	Font, Text Size and Text Color options.

You can save your full Theme Settings as a preset with “Save Theme Settings as a Preset...”, while “Reset Theme Settings” puts everything back to their default version.

Adding Media

There are two ways to add your games, music, photos and videos. Either putting them in the system's content folders yourself, or letting the system find them for you.

Adding Media Manually

Copy your files into their respective category folder inside the system's content folder. The new files show up the next time you open the category in the system.

Folder	What goes in it
content/Music	Songs. Folders inside it become albums.
content/Photos	Pictures. Folders inside it become albums.
content/Videos	Videos. Folders inside it become albums.
content/Subtitles	Subtitle files for your videos.
content/Games	One folder per game (See below).
content/Themes	PS3 Themes and Custom Themes.

When available, media with its own folder will have a .json file that can be manually edited to change information about that specific media file.

▸ Adding a game by hand

Make a folder for an individual game inside content/Games, then put the game's shortcut inside the folder. You can also add pictures and music to the folder to make it look like an actual PS3 game.

File Name	What it does
icon	The game's icon.
background	The background picture shown behind the menu when the game is selected.
preview	An animated icon (A video or GIF).
music	Music that plays when the game is selected.

If you wish to change the name or format for any of the files used, edit the game.json so the file names and file extensions coincide.

A game's details, pictures, video and music can also be edited from inside the system in Settings > Game Settings > Game Information.

Letting the System Find Your Media

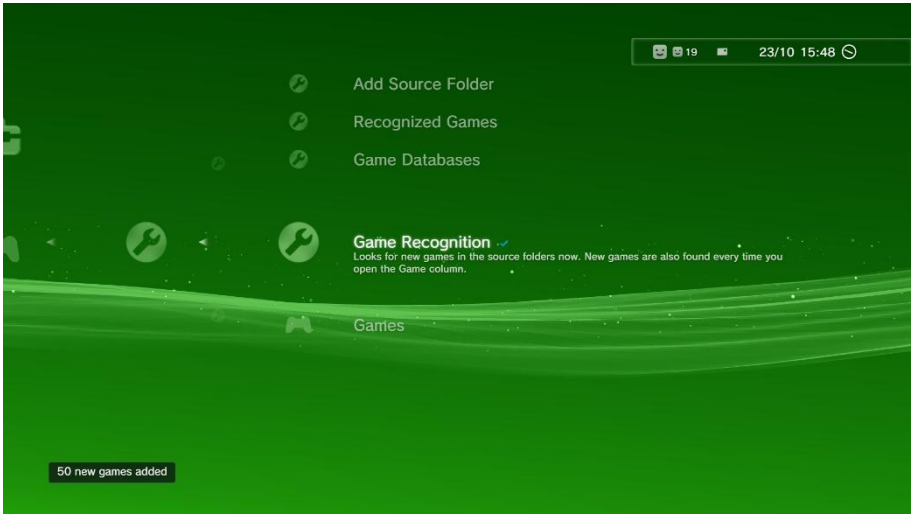
Instead of copying files, you can point the System at the folders where your media already is. Your files stay where they are, as the system only adds shortcuts to them.

▸ Music, photos, videos and subtitles

Go to Settings > System Settings > Media Folders, open the kind of media and choose “Add Folder”. The System recognizes its files right away. File Recognition looks again for new files inside the added folders at any time.

▸ Games

Go to Settings > Game Settings > Game Recognition and choose Add Source Folder. The System finds the games in it and gives each one its own folder in the Game category, with its icon.



- PS3 Games: Add your RPCS3 folder as a source folder and the system finds every PS3 game in it, with its icon, background, animated preview and music. PS3 games then start in RPCS3 straight from the XMB.
- Game Art: The system can download icons, backgrounds and videos from SteamGridDB, TheGamesDB and RAWG. Enter your own API keys in Game Recognition > Game Databases and turn on Automatic Scraping, or use “Get Art Online” when editing the information of an individual game.

NOTE Art that you choose yourself is never replaced by art the system finds later.

Shortcuts and Albums

For every file it finds, the system makes a shortcut and saves it inside its respective content folder. This shortcut is a small file ending in .xmbl that points to the real file. The shortcuts go in the system’s own folders (content/Music, content/Photos or content/Videos), inside a folder named after the source folder the files came from.

▸ Putting your media in albums

Shortcuts can be moved like any other file. Make folders inside content/Music, content/Photos or content/Videos and put shortcuts in them, that way each folder with shortcuts shows in the system as an album. This way, media from different places on your computer can be sorted into your own media albums without touching the real files.

Moving or deleting a shortcut never changes the file it points to. A shortcut you delete isn’t made again the next time the system looks through your folders.

NOTE If you remove a source folder from Media Folders, the shortcuts still in the folders the system made for them are deleted with it. Shortcuts you moved into your own folders stay.

Types of Media

The system can read the most common kinds of media:

Music	Audio files. Song names, artists, albums and covers are read from the files themselves. Some formats are converted with FFmpeg before playing.
Pictures	Picture files, with animated pictures (GIFs) included.
Videos	Video files. Some formats are converted with FFmpeg before playing.
Subtitles	Subtitle files, and subtitles embedded inside video files.
PDFs and comics	Documents and Comic Book files get read page by page in the Photo Viewer (Only inside Custom Sections).
Games	Game files and their shortcuts.
PS3 games	PS3 games played through the RPCS3 emulator.
Programs	Programs, shortcuts and scripts (Only inside Custom Sections).
Themes	PS3 themes and the system's own Custom Themes.

NOTE Converting videos/songs and making video icons need FFmpeg installed (See “Before You Begin”).

Music Player

Select a song in the Music category to open the Music Player. Press ○ to go back to the menu.



Controls

START	Play / Pause.
L1 R1	Previous / Next Song.
L2 R2	Rewind / Fast Forward (Hold to keep going).
□	Change the Visualizer (Placeholder).
SELECT	Change the Display.
△	Show / Hide the Control Panel.
✕	Navigate around and use the Control Panel.
○	Close the Music Player.

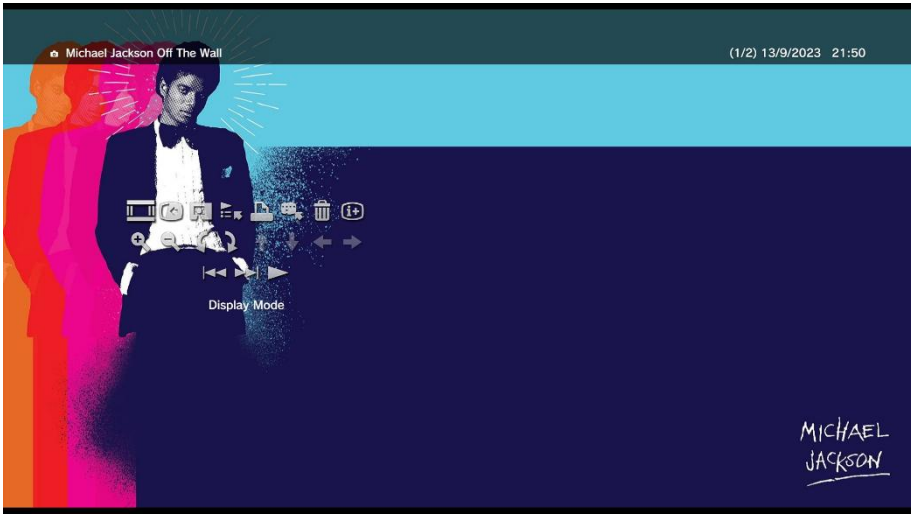
Control Panel

	Volume Control	Change the Volume.
	Visual Player	Change the Visualizer (Placeholder).
	Add to Playlist	Add the current Song playing to a playlist, or make a new one.
	Delete	Delete the Song (Only Songs inside the system's Music folder get actually deleted).
	Display	Show/Hide the Display menu.
	Previous	Go to the Previous Song.
	Next	Go to the Next Song.
	Fast Reverse	Rewind.
	Fast Forward	Fast Forward.
	Play	Play the current Song.
	Pause	Pause the current Song.
	Stop	Stop the current song and go back to the main menu.
	Repeat	Repeat one Song, all Songs, or None.
	Shuffle	Play the Songs in a Random order.

HINT Background Music inside Settings > Music Settings lets you play music while you browse the MaXMB.

Photo Viewer

Select a picture in the Photo category to open it inside the Photo Viewer. PDFs and comics in Custom Sections also open here, separated by pages.



Controls

L1 R1	Previous / Next Picture (Or Page in the case of PDFs or Comic Book files).
L2 R2	Rotate Left / Rotate Right.
START	Start a Slideshow. During the Slideshow it works as Play / Pause.
SELECT	Show the Picture's information or its name.
△	Show / Hide the option menu.
L	Move around a zoomed picture.
R	Zoom In / Zoom Out.
○	Close the Photo Viewer.

Option Menu

	Display Mode	Switch between different Display modes for the current picture.
	Change Effect	Switch the transition that happens from one Picture to another.
	Trimming	Cut out a part of the current Picture and save it as a new Picture.
	Add to Playlist	Add the current Picture to a Photo playlist or create one.
	Print	Print the current Picture.
	Set as Wallpaper	Use the current Picture as the XMB's background.
	Delete	Delete the current Picture (Only Pictures inside the system's Photos folder get actually deleted).
	Display	Show the current Picture's information or name.
	Zoom In / Out	Zoom In / Zoom Out the current Picture.
	Rotate Left / Right	Rotate the current Picture to the Left / Right.
	Up / Down	Move Up / Down around a zoomed Picture.
	Left / Right	Move Left / Right around a zoomed Picture.
	Previous / Next	Go to the Next / Previous Picture.
	Slideshow	Start a Slideshow.

Slideshows

Press START to play your pictures one after another on a Slideshow. Press △ during the Slideshow to see its option menu.

	Slideshow Style	How the Pictures in the Slideshow transition from one to the next.
	Slideshow Speed	How long each Picture stays in the Slideshow before changing to the next one.
	Previous / Next	Go to the Previous / Next Picture in the Slideshow.
	Play / Pause / Stop	Control the Slideshow's flow.
	Repeat	Start the Slideshow again from the first Picture after the last Picture is shown.

Video Player

Select a Video in the Video category to play it. Press ○ to stop it and go back to the main menu.



Controls

START	Play / Pause.
L1	Go back to the beginning of the current Video or go to the Previous Video.
R1	Next Video.
L2 R2	Fast Reverse / Fast Forward. Each press makes it go faster.
□	Scene Search.
SELECT	Show / Hide the Video's information and progress.
△	Show / Hide the Control Panel.
✕	Navigate around and use the Control Panel.
○	Stop the current Video.

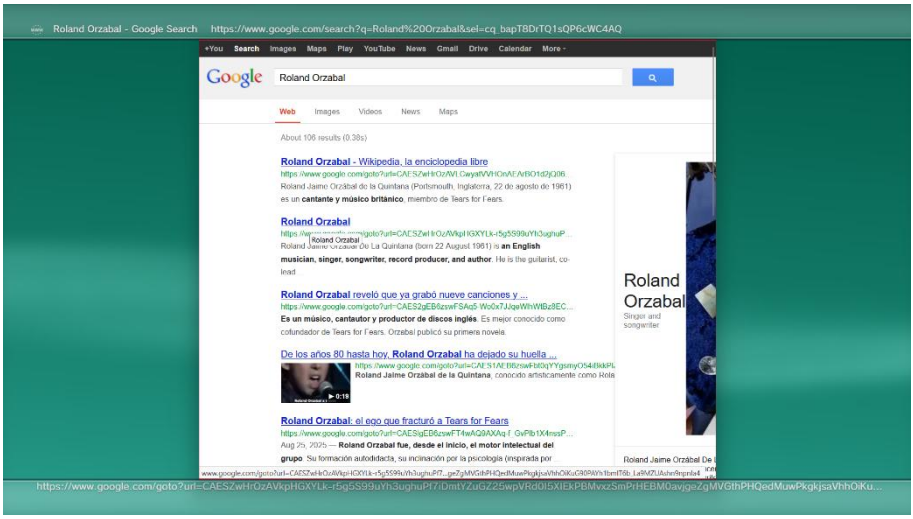
Control Panel

	Scene Search	Jump to a scene, chosen from pictures of the current Video at different intervals.
	Go To	Jump to an exact chosen Time.
	Audio Options	Choose the side(s) of the output from where the audio of the Video is heard.
	Subtitle Options	Turn subtitles on or off, or choose other subtitles.
	Volume Control	Change the Volume.
	Screen Mode	Choose how the Video fills the screen based on the computer's resolution.
	Change Icon	Make a moving icon for the current Video from the current scene onwards to 15 seconds.
	Delete	Delete the current Video (Only Videos inside the system's Videos folder get actually deleted).
	Display	Show / Hide the current Video's information and progress.
	Return to Beginning	Go back to the beginning of the current Video or go to the Previous Video.
	Next	Go to the next Video.
	Fast Reverse / Forward	Move through the current Video quickly.
	Play / Pause / Stop	Control the Video's flow.
	Instant Replay / Advance	Jump back or ahead a few seconds of the current Video.
	Slow (Reverse / Forward)	Play the current Video at half speed.
	Frame Reverse / Advance	Go back or ahead one frame at a time on the current Video.

	Repeat	Automatically play the current Video again when it ends.

Internet Browser

Network > Internet Browser opens the web inside the system, and Internet Search opens a search right away. Direct YouTube access is in TV/Video Services. The browser needs LibreWolf to work (see “Before You Begin”).



Controls

L	Move the Pointer.
✕	Click. Keep it pressed to grab and move the L to drag.
R	Scroll the page.
START	Type an address with the Keyboard.
L1 R1	Back / Forward.
L2 R2	Move to the tab on the Left / Right.
L3	Full Screen On / Off.
○	Close the current tab. Hold it to leave the browser.

HINT Selecting a text box on a page opens the On-Screen Keyboard (If it's turned on). With a keyboard and mouse, the browser works as usual.
Hold Esc to leave the browser.

On-Screen Keyboard

Whenever you need to type with a controller, the On-Screen Keyboard opens in front of the screen. With a computer keyboard you can simply type instead. You can turn the On-Screen Keyboard On or Off in Settings > Accessory Settings.



HINT The @ key opens a panel of extra symbols. The keyboard can also copy and paste the whole text.

Controls

	Move between Keyboard Keys.
	Type the selected Key.
	Space.
	Delete.
L1 R1	Move the cursor Left / Right of the current letter.

	Accented letters On / Off.
	Capital letters and symbols On / Off.
	Confirm.
	Cancel.

PlayStation™Network and Friends

The System has its own PlayStation™Network style accounts. They're kept on your computer only, so they never connect to the real PlayStation™Network or any real network.

Your Account

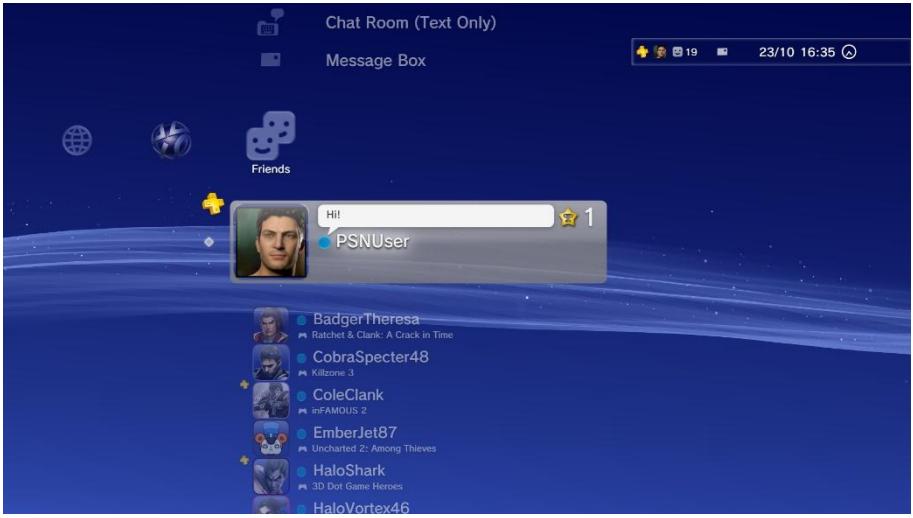
- Sign Up in the PlayStation™Network category with an Online ID, an e-mail address and a password. Next time, choose Sign In.
- Tick Sign In Automatically to be signed in every time your user logs in.
- Account Management lets you change your Online ID, avatar and trophy level, set up your friends, and sign out (With △).

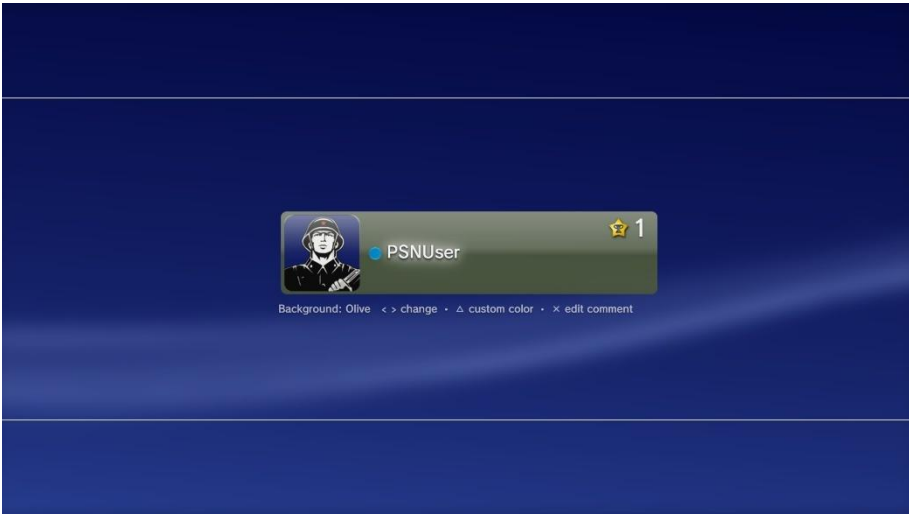
NOTE PSN Avatars are the pictures inside the content/Avatars/PSN folder. Add your own pictures there and reboot the system if you want to add your own avatars.



Friends

Once signed in, the Friends category shows your friends list and your own player card. Select your card to change its color and comment.





Friend Personalization

Go to Account Management > Friend Personalization to decide who your friends are:

	Friend Count	Randomized, Fixed (A specific number you choose) or Range (A random number between a Minimum and a Maximum you choose).
	Create Friend Card	Design a friend of your own. Edit their name, status message, the game they're playing, card color, avatar, online status, trophy level and more. Any detail can be left random if wanted.
	Friend Card Collection	See, edit or delete the friend cards you made. Your created friend cards always take a place among your friends list.

Custom Sections

Custom Sections are categories of your own, placed anywhere on the XMB. Use them for anything you wish. Emulators, comics, documentaries, tools, etc.



Creating a Section

Go to Settings > System Settings > Sections > Create Section and follow the steps. Press ○ at any step to go back one step.

- Icon: Choose a picture from the system's Photos folder for the section's icon.
- Place: Move the section left or right with the ✣, then press ✕ to place it.
- Name and folder type: Name the section and choose whether its folders have the naming conventions of Music, Photo, Video or Game folders.
- Subsections: Add as many subsections as you like, each with its own title, description, icon and folders. Subsections can also hold subsections of their own.

Adding Items

Each new section gets its own folder inside the system's content folder, named after the section. Every item inside a section has its own folder (Like a game does in the content/Games folder). Put a loose file in the section's folder and the system moves it into a its own folder for you. You can also add folders from elsewhere in the section's Folders menu.

Like with games, items inside a Custom Section can have an icon, an animated preview, a background and music. Inside a Custom Section PDFs and comics open in the Photo Viewer, and programs start like games.

Editing a Section

Each section has its own individual menu in Settings > System Settings > Sections, where you can rename it, change its icons, move it, add or remove subsections and folders, or delete it. Press ▣ when on a Custom Section to change the grouping of its items.

Pre-Loading Music and Videos

RECOMMENDED Pre-loading makes songs and videos start straight away and play smoothly, especially on slower computers or with large libraries.

Pre-loading prepares your media ahead of time, so the System doesn't have to do it when you press play.

	Pre-Load All Songs	In Settings > Music Settings. Prepares every song for instant playback.
	Pre-Load All Videos	In Settings > Video Settings. Prepares every video, converting the ones that need it.
	Keep Pre-Loaded Data	Keep Pre-Loaded Songs Data and Keep Pre-Loaded Videos Data keep the prepared files in the System's folder, so they're still ready after a reboot. Otherwise, they're kept in Windows' Temp folder.

Pre-loading can take a while the first time. A counter shows its progress, and you only need to do it again after adding new media.

HINT Settings > System Settings > Cache Management lets you free up space by deleting prepared files, thumbnails and other caches. The caches get automatically prepared again when needed.

Troubleshooting

If something doesn't work as expected, look for it below.

▸ The system doesn't respond

Press F4 on the keyboard to close the system at once, then boot it again.

▸ The system stays behind a game or another window

Press any button on the controller or keyboard to bring the system back to the front once it's on focus.

▸ I get a RPCS3 error when loading into a PS3 game

Inside RPCS3 where the game is located, right click the game inside RPCS3, Manage Game > Create Desktop Shortcut, then move that new game shortcut from the Desktop to inside the game's content/Games folder, delete the .xmbl file and edit the game.json. Once inside the game.json, replace ".xmbl" for ".lnk" on launch.

▸ I forgot the Password or Sign-In ID of my Playstation™Network account

Inside content/data, open psn.json to see all the information of all the created Playstation™Network accounts inside the system.

▸ I have duplicated versions of PS3 games

Delete the versions whose directory doesn't end on EBOOT.BIN inside of Game Settings > Game Recognition > Recognized Games.

▸ A video/song doesn't play, or video icons aren't made

Make sure FFmpeg is installed (See "Before You Begin").

▸ The Internet Browser doesn't open

Make sure LibreWolf's portable version is installed and with its executable inside content/Browser.

▸ The system runs slowly

Try the options in Settings > Power Save Settings, try lowering the Framerate in Display Settings, or use Pre-Loading.

▸ I want to report a bug

Post what happened in the GitHub (https://github.com/MaxiBono/MaXMB) along with the MaXMB.log file that's in content/Logs. If you started the system again after the problem, send MaXMB (previous).log instead.